

RICKY J. SPARKS

TECHNOLOGY PROFESSIONAL

Data Science, Analytics & Technical Support

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SUMMARY

Early-career technology professional with B.S. and M.S. degrees in Computer Science, experience in data analysis and technical support, and graduate research in visualization. Brings Python, SQL, data validation, and clear documentation to data science and analytics roles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data & analytics: Python, SQL, pandas, scikit-learn, Tableau, data validation
Academic research: Comparative study design, Friedman and Wilcoxon tests, uncertainty communication
Engineering & support: Git, Unix/Linux, troubleshooting, QA/QC, requirements, documentation

SELECTED DATA SCIENCE PROJECTS

Uncertainty Communication in Scientific Visualization
Graduate research | California State University, Chico | 2026

- Used Python with Friedman and Wilcoxon tests to compare decision accuracy and response time across three visualization approaches.
- Reported zero errors in 48 hypothetical outcome plot trials; noted small sample size and ceiling effects.

Credit Card Fraud Detection | Learning project, 2019

- Evaluated a decision tree against a majority-class baseline on an 80/20 split of imbalanced transaction data; recorded 71% fraud precision and 72% recall.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Master Chings Auto Inc. | San José, CA

Data Scientist | Sep 2025 - Oct 2026

- Prepared and validated approximately 5,000 customer and service records using SQL joins, CTEs, and window functions.
- Prepared two monthly Tableau reports tracking appointment conversion and repeat visits for sales follow-up reviews.
- Summarized booking trends and data limitations with stakeholders to inform customer follow-up priorities.

Data Analyst | Sep 2024 - Aug 2025

- Reviewed approximately 500 records per week to identify inconsistencies and prepare validated datasets for reporting and analysis.
- Documented metric definitions and data checks to support recurring reports and team handoffs.

Forward Health | San Francisco, CA

Technical Support Engineer | Jun 2022 - Aug 2024

- Diagnosed application issues, reproduced problems, and documented resolution and escalation steps.
- Managed customer communication and escalated complex issues to engineering with reproduction steps.

Course Hero | Redwood City, CA

Metadata Specialist, Contract | Jan 2020 - Apr 2020

- Verified textbook content against source documents and documented metadata and QA procedures.

EDUCATION

California State University, Chico | M.S. Computer Science | May 2026
California State University, East Bay | B.S. Computer Science | May 2024